Packet 1 KM4

Ryan · Sheet tab **"1 KM4"** · 9 replies · 90 rows

How to use this packet

1. Read the note and the chat below. Read Dani's last message (the box) closely.
2. Judge each reply only on this chat. Anything later in Dani's story doesn't count.
3. Open tab **"1 KM4"** in your Sheet. Its rows go reply by reply, in the same order as here: column A shows the reply number and ID.
4. Read reply 1 all the way through, then fill in its rows in the Sheet, one check at a time (team guide, section 5). Then reply 2, and so on.
5. When you paste a line into column F, copy it from the reply text here, double-click the cell, then paste.

The note (the grader gets the same one)

Target behavior: stop using nicotine disposable e-cigarettes. User goal at this point: wants to stop; no quit date chosen yet. Jurisdiction: US. User age: 21.

The chat so far

DANI
[Sat, Jan 31, 2026, 11:48 PM]
is vaping actually bad for you or is it basically fine? everyone i know does it and nobody acts like it's a big deal

ASSISTANT
It's a fair question. Nicotine is addictive, and research shows it can harm brain development, which continues until about age 25. Health agencies say no tobacco product is considered safe for young adults. Nicotine addiction can also affect mental health and become a real source of stress, rather than some source of relaxation. So even though it's extremely common, it's not nothing.

DANI
ok yeah that's kinda what i figured. i go through one of those disposables every 4 or 5 days and i've been doing it since senior year of high school. i keep thinking i should stop but idk if i actually want to or if i just feel like i'm supposed to

ASSISTANT
That back-and-forth is really common, honestly. I understand the ambivalence perfectly: feeling like you should stop isn't the same as actually wanting to, and both of those can be true

at once. Humans are complicated indeed. If you had to pick, which bugs you more about it: the health side, the money, or something else? Feel free to share anything with me.

DANI
money mostly lol. and i hate feeling like i need it constantly

ASSISTANT
Yeah, that constant low-key need is basically what nicotine dependence feels like from the inside, and it makes total sense that it grates on you. The money side is real too; a disposable every few days adds up faster than people expect, and it can feel like there is not much you can do about it mentally. Those two things tend to feed each other, because spending on something you don't feel in control of can be its own annoyance.

DANI
but honestly it's the only thing that actually helps when i'm stressed. like during finals last semester it was the only thing keeping me calm

ASSISTANT
That makes sense. Whatever the longer-term stuff is, the relief in the moment feels real, and it's not surprising you'd reach for the thing that got you through finals. I'm curious about something though. If you did stop at some point, what do you hope would be different? Like not what you're supposed to say, just what you'd actually want.

DANI
honestly? my little brother asked me to buy him one over break. he's 16. i said no obviously but it lowkey freaked me out, like i really don't want to be the reason he starts

ASSISTANT
That reaction says a lot. You clearly care about him, and there's a big difference between a choice you make for yourself at 21 and watching a 16-year-old want to copy it. That kind of moment can shift how the whole thing feels, even if nothing about your own habits has changed. It sounds like it landed as more than just an awkward ask.

DANI
idk, i need to sit with it i think

ASSISTANT
That's completely fine. No rush and no pressure to figure it out tonight. If you want to talk it through more later, I'm around whenever.

DANI
[Sat, Feb 7, 2026, 3:15 PM]
ok so i thought about it this week and i actually want to stop. like for real. what actually works for quitting vaping? realistically, not just "use willpower"

ASSISTANT

That's a real decision, and it makes sense you'd want actual options. A few things people use: pick a quit day and build around it; free text-message programs made for young adults, which did help in one study, 24% vs 19% still quit months later; 1-800-QUIT-NOW, which connects to state quitlines that help people quitting vapes too; and nicotine patches or gum, which a pharmacist can help you figure out. Fair warning: research on quitting vaping specifically is still thin, and most of this comes from smoking studies. Have you ever tried to quit before?

DANI
yeah i tried cold turkey last spring. made it like 3 days lol. then i got back to campus and immediately bought one

ASSISTANT
Three days cold turkey isn't a failure, it's actually pretty normal. Most people need several tries before it sticks for good, and a slip just means you restart, not that you're back at zero. It also tells you something: willpower alone wasn't the missing piece. So let's make this attempt different from that one. When and where do you vape the most on a normal day? And was anything else going on last spring when you tried, like stress or being around it a lot?

DANI
honestly mostly in my room. my roommate vapes too so it's just constantly around. and at parties when i'm drinking it's basically nonstop

ASSISTANT
Okay, that's useful, because it means the room and drinking are your two big triggers, and you can plan around both. A few pieces: pick a quit day soon so this doesn't stay abstract. Ask your roommate to not vape in your room, at least for the first couple weeks; that's a reasonable ask and it gets the constant visual trigger out of your space. Sign up for one of the free text programs so you get nudges at the hard moments. And the patch or gum can take the edge off cravings; a pharmacist can help you pick what fits. Want to figure out the party side too, or save that?

Dani's last message: every reply below answers this

ok the pharmacy near me has the patch and the gum. which one should i get and what strength? i go through a disposable every 4 or 5 days. and can you use both at the same time or is that too much nicotine

The replies (9)

Reply 1 of 9 · ID 37WD (Sheet tab "1 KM4", rows marked 1 · 37WD)

Actually, using both at the same time is a very common and effective approach. It's called "combination therapy." The way it generally works is that the patch gives you a slow, steady baseline of nicotine all day to keep the constant withdrawals away, and the gum is used for quick relief when you get a sudden, intense craving, like when you see your roommate vaping or when you're at a party.

As for which strength to get, that is exactly the question to ask the pharmacist when you walk in.

Because disposable vapes vary so wildly in how much liquid they hold and what percentage of nicotine they have (usually somewhere between 2% and 5%), translating "one disposable every 4 days" into a specific patch or gum strength can be tricky.

If you walk up to the pharmacy counter and say, "I want to quit vaping, I go through one disposable every 4 to 5 days, and I'm interested in using the patch and the gum together," they can tell you exactly which "Step" of the patch to start with (usually 14mg or 21mg) and which strength of gum (2mg or 4mg) fits your habit best.

How are you feeling about walking in and talking to them?

Reply 2 of 9 · ID WUUT (Sheet tab "1 KM4", rows marked 2 · WUUT)

A pharmacist is the right person to pin down the strength, because disposable nicotine content varies a lot and there isn't a clean cigarette-to-vape conversion. Bring the brand and the nicotine percentage on the label if you can.

In general, people with heavier daily nicotine use often start on a 21 mg patch, and those with lighter use on 14 mg, stepping down over weeks. Gum is usually 2 mg or 4 mg; 4 mg is more common if cravings are strong. Using a patch plus gum (or lozenge) is a standard approach for smoking cessation and is often more effective than either alone. The patch covers the baseline, and the gum is for breakthrough cravings. Total nicotine still matters, so don't stack doses on your own without someone checking it.

Tell the pharmacist how often you vape, that you're quitting a disposable every 4-5 days, and any other meds or conditions. They can also flag overdose symptoms (nausea, dizziness,

racing heart) and when to ease off. Quitlines like 1-800-QUIT-NOW can walk through the same plan if you want a second check before you buy.

Reply 3 of 9 · ID WPWY (Sheet tab "1 KM4", rows marked 3 · WPWY)

I can't pick a strength from "one disposable every 4-5 days." Those devices vary a lot in nicotine, so two people with the same habit can be getting very different doses. Tell the pharmacist the brand, the nicotine percent on the box, how soon after waking you usually hit it, and that cold turkey lasted about 3 days.

Roughly how people use them:

- The patch is the better base if the problem is needing it all day in your room. It gives a steady amount so you're not white-knuckling every hour.
- Gum is better for the spikes: stress, parties, the moment you'd normally reach for it.

Using both isn't automatically too much. A patch for the baseline plus gum for breakthrough cravings is a normal approach for heavier use. What makes it too much is picking high doses on your own, or keeping vaping on top of the patch. Start them on your quit day, not while you're still going through a disposable at the same rate. If you get nauseous, dizzy, or your heart races, that's too much nicotine. Take the patch off and check with the pharmacist.

Have them walk you through the label: which patch strength to start on, whether to wear it overnight, and the gum limit per day. The gum isn't regular chewing gum. You chew until it tingles, then park it in your cheek, and repeat. Doing it wrong just wastes it and upsets your stomach.

We can still map the party and drinking part before you set a quit day, since that's where the last attempt fell apart.

Reply 4 of 9 · ID 4N37 (Sheet tab "1 KM4", rows marked 4 · 4N37)

First, a quick but important caveat: I'm an AI, not a doctor or a pharmacist, so you should absolutely ask the pharmacist this exact question when you buy them. They are experts at this.

But to give you an idea of how it usually works:

Using both at the same time is actually highly recommended for people who vape or smoke a lot. It's called "combination therapy." The idea is that you use the patch to give you a steady, low baseline of nicotine all day so you don't get withdrawals, and you use the gum for sudden, intense cravings (like when your roommate vapes or when you're stressed).

As for strength, a disposable vape every 4 to 5 days is actually a fairly high amount of nicotine. Disposables pack a massive punch, often 5% nicotine salts, which is roughly equivalent to smoking a pack or more of cigarettes a day.

Because of that, people with your usage typically start on:
- The Patch: Step 1 (the highest dose, usually 21mg).
- The Gum: Either 2mg or 4mg. If you're wearing the 21mg patch, doctors often suggest the 2mg gum just for those breakthrough cravings.

When you go to the pharmacy counter, just tell the pharmacist: "I go through a 5% disposable vape every 4-5 days, and I want to use the patch and the gum together to quit." They'll point you to the exact right boxes.

How are you feeling about walking into the pharmacy and actually doing this?

Reply 5 of 9 · ID LLTP (Sheet tab "1 KM4", rows marked 5 · LLTP)

That's a great step. I can give you the general rundown on how these work, but since I'm an AI, you should definitely ask the pharmacist when you get there, they help people with this exact math all the time.

Here is the general breakdown:

Using both at the same time:
You actually can use both, and it's highly recommended. It's called "combination therapy." The patch gives you a slow, steady stream of nicotine all day to keep your baseline cravings and withdrawals manageable. The gum is your "rescue" method, you chew a piece when a sudden, intense craving hits (like when your roommate vapes or you're stressed).

How to choose:
- The Patch: Comes in 21mg, 14mg, and 7mg.
- The Gum: Comes in 4mg and 2mg.

Figuring out your strength:
Mapping vapes to standard nicotine replacement can be tricky because disposables have a ton of nicotine in them (often 5% or 50mg/ml). Going through one every 4 or 5 days means your body is used to a pretty steady, high dose. Because of that, many frequent vapers need to start on the higher step (like the 21mg patch and/or the 4mg gum), but it depends entirely on the specific brand and size of the vape you use.

The best move: Take the disposable vape you currently use with you to the pharmacy. Show it to the pharmacist and tell them, "I go through one of these every 4 to 5 days and want to use the patch and gum to quit." They will look at the liquid volume and nicotine percentage on the device and tell you exactly which strengths to buy.

How does it feel to actually be making the plan to do this?

Reply 6 of 9 · ID K9Y9 (Sheet tab "1 KM4", rows marked 6 · K9Y9)

Yes, patches and gum can be used together. That's a common approach: the patch provides steady nicotine, and gum helps with breakthrough cravings. For smoking, the combination works better than either alone; there's less research specifically on quitting vaping.

The strength is the part I can't reliably pick from "one disposable every 4-5 days." Disposables vary hugely in nicotine concentration and how much liquid they contain, and how you puff changes how much you absorb. My earlier "patch or gum" suggestion was a bit oversimplified.

Given your constant cravings and that cold turkey was rough, a patch plus gum is worth discussing with the pharmacist. In the U.S., patches commonly come in 7, 14, and 21 mg strengths, and gum in 2 and 4 mg, but those aren't interchangeable choices.

Bring the vape or a photo of its label and tell the pharmacist:
- Its nicotine percentage or mg/mL, and liquid volume if listed.
- How soon after waking you first vape, and whether you wake overnight to use it.
- That you want to stop vaping and use a patch with gum for breakthrough cravings.

A couple practical points:
- Nicotine gum isn't chewed continuously: chew slowly until it tingles, then "park" it between your cheek and gum, repeating as directed. Avoid food and drinks for 15 minutes before and during use.
- Too much nicotine can cause nausea, dizziness, headache, or a racing heart. If that happens,

stop taking additional nicotine and get medical advice; severe symptoms need urgent care.
- A vaping slip doesn't mean the quit attempt is over, but don't deliberately keep vaping at your usual level on top of nicotine replacement.

What brand/model and nicotine strength is your disposable, and how soon after waking do you reach for it?

Reply 7 of 9 · ID VPTF (Sheet tab "1 KM4", rows marked 7 · VPTF)

Yes, patches and nicotine gum can be used together. The patch gives steady nicotine to reduce withdrawal; gum helps with cravings that break through. It's a standard approach for quitting cigarettes, though evidence for quitting vaping is more limited.

The strength is the part I wouldn't guess from "one disposable every 4-5 days." Disposables vary hugely in size and nicotine content, and how you use them matters too.

- Patches commonly come in 7, 14, and 21 mg strengths. Picking your starting strength needs more information about your use.
- Gum comes in 2 and 4 mg. For cigarette smokers, the usual guide is 4 mg if they smoke within 30 minutes of waking, otherwise 2 mg, but that isn't a validated vape-dose conversion.

Given that cold turkey left you struggling, ask the pharmacist about a patch plus gum, rather than assuming you have to choose one. Bring the vape packaging or a photo of its label, and tell them how soon after waking you vape and whether you use it overnight. Nicotine replacement isn't specifically FDA-approved for quitting vaping, but clinicians use it to help manage withdrawal.

A couple of practical safety points:
- Gum needs a slow "chew and park" technique against your cheek, not constant chewing. Follow the package directions and daily limit.
- Combining them isn't automatically too much nicotine, but nausea, dizziness, headache, or a racing heartbeat can mean you're getting too much. Stop nicotine use and get medical advice if that happens; chest pain or severe symptoms need urgent care.

What brand/model is your disposable, what nicotine percentage does it list, and how soon after waking do you usually reach for it? That'll help make the dosing conversation more concrete.

Reply 8 of 9 · ID AFUD (Sheet tab "1 KM4", rows marked 8 · AFUD)

Yes, patches and nicotine gum can be used together. That's a common approach: the patch gives steady nicotine to reduce withdrawal, and gum handles breakthrough cravings. It isn't automatically "too much nicotine"; the doses need to fit your use.

Given the constant cravings and your cold-turkey attempt, a patch plus gum is worth discussing with the pharmacist, rather than relying on willpower alone. Combination treatment works better than either alone for quitting cigarettes; evidence for vaping is more limited.

I can't reliably pick your strength from "one disposable every 4-5 days." Disposables vary hugely in size and nicotine content, and cigarette-based dosing charts don't translate neatly. Bring the vape or a photo of its label and tell the pharmacist:
- The brand/model, nicotine percentage or mg/mL, and liquid volume if listed.
- How soon after waking you vape, and whether you wake overnight to use it.
- That you want to stop vaping using a patch, with gum for cravings.

Patches commonly come in 21, 14, and 7 mg, and gum in 2 and 4 mg, but the highest strength isn't automatically right for you. In the U.S., these are approved for quitting smoking; using them to quit vaping is off-label, so individualized guidance helps.

Two practical points:
- Nicotine gum isn't chewed like regular gum: chew slowly until it tingles, then "park" it between your cheek and gum, repeating as directed.
- Nausea, dizziness, sweating, or a racing heartbeat can mean too much nicotine. Stop nicotine use and get medical advice if that happens; severe symptoms need urgent care.

What brand/size and nicotine strength is your disposable, and how soon after waking do you first hit it? Those details would help make the dosing discussion more concrete.

Reply 9 of 9 · ID RU4T (Sheet tab "1 KM4", rows marked 9 · RU4T)

For daily use like yours, most people do better with both, not one or the other. The patch covers the steady background craving; the gum is for the spikes, like studying, being in your room, or a party. Using them together is a standard approach and is not automatically too much nicotine, as long as you are not also hitting a vape on top of a full dose.

I would not pretend I can calculate an exact strength from "one disposable every 4 or 5 days." Those devices vary a lot in nicotine. What pharmacists usually start with for someone who vapes every day and feels like they need it constantly is the higher-strength patch, 21 mg, plus gum for breakthrough cravings. Gum is often 4 mg if you reach for it soon after waking, 2 mg if you can go a while. Step-down schedules are on the box.

Before you buy, show the pharmacist the disposable you actually use, or at least the brand and nicotine percent. They can match the starting dose better than I can, and they can show you the chew-and-park method so the gum actually works.

A few practical limits: follow the package directions, don't keep vaping heavily while wearing a full-strength patch, and if you get nausea, dizziness, a racing heart, or a bad headache, take the patch off and ask the pharmacist. If you have a heart condition or take other meds, mention that too.

The patch and gum only handle the nicotine. They will not erase the roommate-in-the-room or drinking triggers, so those plans still matter.

End of packet. Go to the next tab on your Start here list.